

Alex P. Leith, PhD

Curriculum Vitae

Associate Professor (Tenured), Mass Communications, Southern Illinois University Edwardsville
Founder & Principal Research Consultant, SIM-DAD LLC

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Academic Appointments

Associate Professor (Tenured 2025) — Director, AURA Lab @ SIUE Department of Mass Communications, College of Arts & Sciences, Southern Illinois University Edwardsville (SIUE), Edwardsville, IL · Aug 2025 – present

AURA Lab (Avatars, Users, Relationships, and Affect Lab) — rebranded May 2026 from the former SIM Lab (Social & Interactive Media Lab) — is a computational communication research group at SIUE studying how people form relationships, perform identity, and experience affect across virtual environments, streaming platforms, and digital media. Affiliated with the Beyond Meet Space (BMS) initiative on virtual presence and remote work, a multi-institutional research partnership.

Assistant Professor (Tenure-track) Department of Mass Communications, College of Arts & Sciences, Southern Illinois University Edwardsville (SIUE), Edwardsville, IL · Aug 2019 – Jul 2025

Additional Academic & Teaching Appointments

Adjunct Instructor: Southern Illinois University Edwardsville — Aug–Dec 2011; St. Louis College of Pharmacy — Aug 2011 – May 2012; McKendree University — Jan–May 2012

Graduate Training / Graduate Appointments

Graduate Assistant, Michigan State University — Sep 2012 – May 2017 Graduate Assistant, Southern Illinois University Edwardsville — Aug 2010 – May 2011

Industry & Consulting Experience

Founder & Principal Research Consultant — SIM-DAD LLC Independent research and data consulting practice | Remote · Jun 2024 – present

Applied behavioral research, UX/user research, and data analytics consulting for technology, media, and gaming clients. Open-source NLP and AI tooling.

- Built **TASS** (Text Analysis & Sentiment System), a Python/R NLP package for word count and sentiment analysis with extensible custom dictionaries — github.com/SIM-DAD/TASS
- Deployed **The Cage**, a production Next.js / TypeScript web application with dual-database architecture (PostgreSQL + MySQL / Prisma ORM), Docker Compose, REST API, QR checkout, and Microsoft Entra SSO — github.com/SIM-DAD/the-cage
- Developed **Open WebUI Launcher for Local LLMs**: one-click Python/Docker tool automating LLM setup (Ollama + Open WebUI) with hardware checks and classroom-safe defaults — github.com/apleith/open-webui-launcher
- Maintaining **DeepSeek-R1 monorepo** of Open WebUI tools for research and instructional AI workflows — github.com/SIM-DAD/DeepSeek-R1-Monorepo

Marketing Manager — Brigham Young University–Idaho Marketing & Communications | Rexburg, ID · Aug 2008 – Aug 2009

Education

Doctor of Philosophy, Information and Media (Media and Information) · 2019 Michigan State University *Dissertation*: Gameplay livestreaming: Agents of gamespace *Committee*: Rabindra Ratan (Chair), Casey O'Donnell, Morgan Ellithorpe, Brandon Van Der Heide

Master of Arts, Speech Communication (Interpersonal Communication) · 2011 Southern Illinois University Edwardsville *Thesis*: I know what you did last night: Exploring parasocial Facebook relationships *Committee*: Jocelyn DeGroot-Brown (Chair), Alicia Alexander, E. Duff Wrobbel

Bachelor of Arts, Communication (Public Relations) · 2009 Brigham Young University – Idaho *Clusters*: English and Philosophy

Publications

Leith, A. P., Lim, C., Foxman, M., Beyea, D., & Jeong, D. C. (2025). Stress and coping in VRChat: A mixed-method case study of the use of VRChat as a coping tool during the COVID-19 pandemic. *Computers in Human Behavior Reports*, 20(100843). <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chbr.2025.100843>

Bouzek, D., Foxman, M., Lim, C., & Leith, A. P. (2025). Balancing fun and professionalism in game development: the dark and light side of play in virtual meetings. *Frontiers in Communication*, 10. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fcomm.2025.1609776>

Ratan, R. A., Lin, Q., Lim, C., Park, R., Lover, A., Han, E., Jang, D., Leith, A. P., & Bailenson, J. N. (2025). Time matters in VR: Students benefit from longer VR class duration, but certain outcomes decline after 45 minutes, with large individual variance. *Computers & Education*, 14(3), 466–477. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.compedu.2025.105328>

Lim, C., Leith, A. P., Ratan, R., & Bouzek, D. (2025). Meeting needs: How social interaction anxiety, zoom fatigue, relatedness, and demographics predict virtual meeting feature preferences. *Computers in Human Behavior Reports*, 18, 100673. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chbr.2025.100673>

Lim, C., Ratan, R., Foxman, M., Beyea, D., Jeong, D., & Leith, A. P. (2025). Examining attitudes about the virtual workplace: Associations between Zoom fatigue, Impression management, and virtual meeting adoption intent. *PLOS One*. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0312354>

Beyea, D., Lim, C., Lover, A., Foxman, M., Ratan, R., & Leith, A. P. (2025). Zoom fatigue in review: A meta-analytical examination of videoconferencing fatigue's antecedents. *Computers in Human Behavior Reports*, 17(100571). <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chbr.2025.100571>

Foxman, M., Beyea, D., Leith, A. P., Ratan, R. A., Chen, V. H. H., & Klebig, B. (2022). Beyond genre: Classifying virtual reality experiences. *IEEE Transactions on Games*, 14(3), 466–477. <https://doi.org/10.1109/TG.2021.3119521>

Leith, A. P., & Gheen, E. (2022). Twitch in the time of quarantine: The role of engagement in needs fulfillment. *Psychology of Popular Media*, 11(3), 275–280. <https://doi.org/10.1037/ppm0000372>

Leith, A. P. (2021). Parasocial cues: The ubiquity of parasocial relationships on Twitch. *Communication Monographs*, 88(1), 111–129. <https://doi.org/10.1080/03637751.2020.1868544>

Ratan, R. A., Fordham, J., Leith, A. P., & Williams, D. (2019). Women keep it real: Avatar gender choice in League of Legends. *Cyberpsychology, Behavior, and Social Networking*, 22, 254–257. <https://doi.org/10.1089/cyber.2018.0302>

DeGroot, J. M., & Leith, A. P. (2018). R.I.P. Kutner: Parasocial grief following the death of a television character. *OMEGA — Journal of Death and Dying*, 77, 199–216. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0030222815600450>

Leith, A. P., Ratan, R. A., & Wohn, D. Y. (2016). The (de-)evolution of evolution games: Analyzing the accuracy of evolution depiction in video games. *Journal of Science Education and Technology*, 25, 655–664. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10956-016-9620-x>

Editorials

Beyea, D., Foxman, M., Ratan, R., Klebig, B., Leith, A. P., & Chen, V. H. H. (2025). Metaverse-mediated communication: A call for theory-driven XR research [Editorial]. *Journal of Media Psychology: Theories, Methods, and Applications*, 37(2), 61–63. <https://doi.org/10.1027/1864-1105/a000465>

Funding

External Funding (Completed)

NSF FW-HTF-R Collaborative Research, Co-PI. *Virtual Meeting Support for Enhanced Well-Being and Equity for Game Developers*. \$1,599,851 (SIUE subaward \$70,458); 2021–2025. Cross-institutional partnership with Michigan State, University of Oregon, and industry collaborators in the games and virtual-environment sector.

External Funding (Under Review)

Spencer Foundation Racial Equity Research Grants, PI. *At the Margins of Two Systems: Paraprofessionals, AI Tools, and Multilingual Neurodiverse Learners in K-5 Classrooms*. \$75,000 (no-IDC ceiling); 09/2026 – 08/2028. ITA submitted 2026-05-04; full proposal due 2026-07-01.

Wellcome Discovery Award, Co-Investigator (SIUE Lead, with University of Zambia PI). *AI-Driven and IoT-Enabled Innovations for Malaria and Insect Vector Surveillance and Control*. \$800,044; 01/2026 – 12/2030.

External Funding (Submitted, Not Funded)

NSF Future CoRe (HCC), PI. *Distributed AI Agents for Scalable Interaction Modeling and Feedback Aggregation in Technical Learning*. \$496,521; 06/2026 – 05/2030; SIUE. Submitted 2025-09-11; decision 2026-05-03.

NSF Collaborative Research, PI (SIUE site). *Improving Equity and Wellbeing in Virtual Classrooms via AI-enhanced Avatars*. \$49,999; 05/2025 – 05/2028; SIUE.

Spencer Foundation, PI. *Innovating for Inclusivity: Mixed Reality and Digital Learning Modalities as Educational Equalizers*. \$249,884; 2025.

NEH Dangers and Opportunities of Technology, Co-PI (with A. Speno, Co-PI). \$149,975; 2024.

Internal Funding

Leith, A. P. (2025–2026). OER Faculty Incentive Program: Vibes to Variables (V2V) Courseware Umbrella. \$7,792.37. SIUE Online Services & Educational Outreach.

Leith, A. P. (2024). OER Faculty Incentive Program. \$5,110.74. SIUE.

Leith, A. P. (2023–2024). OER Adoption, Adaptation, and Implementation Incentive Program. \$6,088. SIUE.

Leith, A. P. (2021–2022). New Faculty Incentive Program. \$2,000. SIUE.

Industry & Foundation Research Partnerships

Beyond Meet Space (BMS) Initiative. Cross-institutional research collective on virtual presence and remote work, founded ~2020. Industry and platform partners include game studios and the VRChat platform; institutional partners across multiple universities. Active research outputs in journals including *Computers in Human Behavior Reports*, *PLOS One*, *IEEE Transactions on Games*, and *Frontiers in Communication*.

Graduate Mentoring & Student Supervision

Cross-unit mentoring at SIUE spanning Mass Communications, Applied Communication Studies, Integrative Studies, Environmental Sciences, and Psychology.

Master's Project / Thesis Committee Chair

- Michelle Poneleit, Integrative Studies. Oct 2025 – present.

Master's Project / Thesis Committee Member

- Gabriel Simpson, Mass Communications. Nov 2024 – May 2025.
- Maria Gomez Torne, Mass Communications. Nov 2024 – May 2025.
- Emonvuon Magdalene, Mass Communications. Jun 2024 – Jan 2025.
- Andrew Heaslet, Environmental Sciences (cross-unit). *Midwestern Climate Policymaking on Twitter: Policy Entrepreneurs and Framing in the Debate that Led to Illinois' Climate and Equitable Jobs Act*. May – Dec 2024.
- Abdurrahman Celik, Mass Communications. *#BrandWars on Instagram: A Deep Analysis of User Comments on Instagram to Have a Better Understanding About Competitive and Comparative Advertising on Social Media*. Aug 2023 – Jul 2024.
- Ashlyn Smith, Mass Communications. *Modernizing Advertising Techniques for Non-Profit Radio Stations with Social Media: The Case of WSIE*. Nov 2021 – Aug 2022.
- Kain Henson, Integrative Studies. *Sports Teams' Social Media Strategies and Audience Engagement*. Nov 2020 – Aug 2021.
- Rachel Berg, Integrative Studies. *The Rebranding of Skinn Fitness Aesthetics to Skinn Aesthetics*. Apr 2020 – May 2021.

Graduate Exam Committee

- Claire Chulka, Mass Communications. Feb – Apr 2024.
- Lenny Escarlet Montano Claire, Mass Communications. Jan – Apr 2021.

Directed Individual / Independent Study

- Amanda Cooper, Mass Communications. *Small Audience Streamer Gender Expectations, Pressures, and Behaviors on Twitch.tv*. Aug – Dec 2020.

URCA Mentor (SIUE Undergraduate Research and Creative Activities)

- Dallas Creech, Mass Communications. Aug – Dec 2020.
- Erin Gheen, Applied Communication Studies (cross-unit). Aug – Dec 2020. Coauthor on Leith & Gheen (2022), *Psychology of Popular Media*.
- Olivia Buente, Psychology (cross-unit). Aug – Dec 2020.
- Dakota Kasper, Mass Communications. Jan – May 2020.
- Samuel Baker, Psychology (cross-unit). Jan – May 2020. Coauthor on Leith & Baker (2020) NCA paper on machine-learning identification of racial harassment in Twitch chat.

Senior Assignment Supervision

- Thomas Yancey, Integrative Studies. *Thomas Yancey Website Portfolio*. Sep 2021 – Feb 2021.
- Stephanie Schrage, Integrative Studies. Jan – May 2020.

Intellectual Property & Technology Transfer (SIUE)

GearOut (formerly Control Room / The Cage). Equipment reservation and checkout platform for universities; deployed at SIUE as “MassComm Checkout.” 155 files, 21.5K LoC, 57 API routes, 21 models. Sole developer (300+ hours). Disclosed via SIUE OTMIR (Office of Technology Management & Industry Relations); IP package, commercial viability analysis, and licensing-back proposal submitted; OTMIR review meeting 2026-04-13. Repository: github.com/SIM-DAD/gearout.

BMS Selective Muting Evaluation (with team). MSU Technologies-led Invention Disclosure submitted 2026-05-08; Alex as 1 of 8 contributors at 15% SIUE-affiliated contribution per SIU IP policy. Cross-institutional patent disclosure originating from FW-HTF-R research.

Intellectual Contributions in Submission (Under Review)

Leith, A. P., Lim, C., Foxman, M., Beyea, D., & Jeong, D. Dreaming a Virtual Reality: Identifying Interpersonal and Intrapersonal Motivations in VRChat During the COVID-19 Pandemic. *International Journal of Communication*.

Lim, C., Ratan, R., Foxman, M., Beyea, D., Jeong, D., & Leith, A. P. Virtual Touch-up: Examining how use of Impression Management features in virtual meetings relates to Zoom Fatigue and VM Perceptions. *Behaviour & Information Technology*.

Leith, A. P. When watching isn't enough: Human agents and their influence of gameplay through synchronous text chats. *Journal of Gaming & Virtual Worlds*.

Ratan, R., Lin, Q., Lim, C., Lover, A., Han, E., Jang, D., Park, R., Leith, A. P., & Bailenson, J. N. Virtual reality enhances online classes due to social presence, but benefits diminish after about 30 minutes due to fatigue: A longitudinal study of undergraduates. *Computers & Education*.

Lim, C., Leith, A. P., Ratan, R., Foxman, M., & Bouzek, D. Supporting underrepresented workers' well-being in virtual meetings: An exploratory study linking uses and gratification, self-determination theory to usage of virtual meeting features. *Computers in Human Behavior Reports*.

Beyea, D., Lim, C., Foxman, M., Ratan, R., & Leith, A. P. Videoconferencing fatigue: An analysis of antecedents and the ZEF Scale. *Computers in Human Behavior Reports*.

Leith, A. P., Foxman, M., et al. The Platform Flattening of Gendered Affect (P5). *Information, Communication & Society*. Submitted 2026-04-25.

Open-Source Software & Datasets

Open-Source Software

- **TASS** (Text Analysis & Sentiment System, Python/R NLP package) — 2024–present. github.com/SIM-DAD/TASS
- **Open WebUI Launcher for Local LLMs** (Python/Docker) — 2025–present. github.com/apleith/open-webui-launcher
- **GearOut** (formerly Control Room / The Cage) — Equipment reservation and checkout platform for universities; Next.js / TypeScript / PostgreSQL / MySQL / Docker production web app, deployed at SIUE as “MassComm Checkout.” 2024–present. github.com/SIM-DAD/gearout
- **Mass Communications Careers Dashboard** (SvelteKit) — 2025–present. github.com/AURA-Lab-SIUE/mc-careers-dashboard
- **mccoursepack** (R package for reproducible course delivery; component of the Vibes to Variables (V2V) courseware umbrella, an OER toolkit for teaching research methods to students new to statistics, methods, and coding) — 2025–present. github.com/AURA-Lab-SIUE/mccoursepack
- **V2V Hub** (supplemental research methods website; rebrand and redesign of the legacy Open Methods Hub site) — 2025–present.
- **DeepSeek-R1 Monorepo** (Open WebUI research/instructional AI tools) — 2025–present. github.com/SIM-DAD/DeepSeek-R1-Monorepo

Research Datasets (restricted access; ToS/IRB governed)

- **Twitch Chat Logs** (Dec 17, 2018 – Jan 17, 2019): 117,943 channels; 321,189,309 messages. Access: Restricted.
 - **VRChat Tweets** (Jan 16, 2014 – May 25, 2023): 1,434,367 original English-language tweets. Access: Restricted.
 - **Remote Work Tweets** (April 2020 & April 2021): 1,409,966 tweets from 887,888 unique users. Access: Restricted.
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Books & OER

Reviewed Book

Leith, A. P. (2024). *Quantitative research in mass communications: R and RStudio*. Bookdown. https://bookdown.org/alex_leith/mc451/

Book Chapters

Fordham, J., Leith, A. P., & Ratan, R. A. (2017). League of Legends: Summoning a league of their own. In J. Banks, R. Mejia, & A. Adams (Eds.), *100 greatest video game franchises* (pp. 102–104). Rowman & Littlefield.

Leith, A. P., & Fordham, J. (2017). Assassin’s Creed: Leap of faith through historiophoty. In J. Banks, R. Mejia, & A. Adams (Eds.), *100 greatest video game franchises* (pp. 11–12). Rowman & Littlefield.

Leith, A. P., & Ratan, R. A. (2017). Super Smash Bros.: Fight with the one that brung ya. In J. Banks, R. Mejia, & A. Adams (Eds.), *100 greatest video game franchises* (pp. 178–180). Rowman & Littlefield.

Refereed Proceedings

Lim, C., Leith, A. P., Foxman, M., Ratan, R., & Klebig, B. (2025, January). The Hyperpersonal Model of Communication in virtual meetings. *Proceedings of the 58th Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences*.

Milik, O., Jang, D., Foxman, M., Klebig, B., Beyea, D., Leith, A. P., & Ratan, R. (2024, November). Focusing on virtual groups: A method for focus group interviews in XR/VR group settings. *AoIR Selected Papers of Internet Research, 2024*.

Foxman, M., Bouzek, D., Lim, C., Ratan, R., Klebig, B., Leith, A. P., & Beyea, D. (2024, July). Making a virtual playground: Values-based game design in meeting platforms. *DiGRA 2024 Conference: Playgrounds*.

Lim, C., Foxman, M., Leith, A. P., Meshi, D., & Ratan, R. (2024, July). Wanting playfulness to counter fatigue from virtual meetings. *DiGRA 2024 Conference: Playgrounds*.

Foxman, M., Bouzek, D., Ratan, R. A., & Leith, A. (2023, June). Virtually Limited: Boundaries of Play in Virtual Reality Production. *DiGRA 2023 Conference: Limits and Margins of Games*.

Leith, A., Foxman, M., Onuche, M., Ratan, R., & Lim, C. (2023, June). Mixed Feelings and Realities: Joyful to Nauseating Sentiments about VR on Twitter. *DiGRA 2023 Conference: Limits and Margins of Games*.

Foxman, M., Leith, A. P., Beyea, D., Klebig, B., Chen, V. H. H., & Ratan, R. (2020, November). Virtual reality genres: Comparing preferences in immersive experiences and games. *CHI PLAY '20: Extended Abstracts* (pp. 237–241). ACM. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3383668.3419881>

Leith, A. P. (2019, October). Playing games for others: Constructing a gameplay livestreaming taxonomy. *Proceedings of Meaningful Play 2018* (pp. 372–379). ETC Press. <https://doi.org/10.1184/R1/9995969>

Invited Talks

Leith, A. P., Freberg, K., Wall, M., & Dalton, S. (2020, May). How to teach digital and social media marketing well. Panel presented at the *Midwest Digital Marketing Conference*. St. Louis, MO.

Conference Papers (Selected)

Milik, O., Ratan, R., Chen, V., Pandita, S., Foxman, M., & Leith, A. P. (2025, June). Looking Beyond Meet Space: Presenting a Research Platform in VRChat. *International Communication Association 75th Annual Conference*. Denver, CO.

Leith, A. P., Lim, C., Foxman, M., Beyea, D., & Jeong, D. (2025, June). Stress and Coping in VRChat. *International Communication Association 75th Annual Conference*. Denver, CO.

Leith, A. P., Foxman, M., Lim, C., & Beyea, D. (2025, June). What ASD finds in VRChat: The potential for VR to address communication barriers for individuals with Autism Spectrum Disorder. *ICA 75th Annual Conference*. Denver, CO.

Beyea, D., Lim, C., Lover, A., Foxman, M., Ratan, R., & Leith, A. P. (2024, June). Zoom fatigue? A meta-analytical examination of research on the antecedents of videoconferencing fatigue. *ICA 74th Annual Conference*. Gold Coast, QLD.

Foxman, M., Bouzek, D., Lim, C., & Leith, A. P. (2024, June). Playing from home: Identity, cohesion, and communication for remote game makers. *ICA 74th Annual Conference*. Gold Coast, QLD.

Foxman, M., Leith, A. P., Ratan, R., & Bouzek, D. (2023, May). Playfully Virtual: Finding Authentic Communication in Videoconferencing and Online Meetings. *ICA 73rd Annual Conference*. Toronto, ON.

Leith, A. P., Foxman, M., Onuche, M., & Bouzek, D. (2023, May). Diffusion of gratification: The reception of VR as a modality for remote work and meetings. *ICA 73rd Annual Conference*. Toronto, ON.

Leith, A. P., Foxman, M., Ratan, R., & Lim, C. (2023, May). Feelings for meetings: A sentiment analysis of videoconferencing platforms a year apart. *ICA 73rd Annual Conference*. Toronto, ON.

Leith, A. P., & Baker, S. (2020, November). Cmonbruh, trihard: Using machine-learning to identify racial harassment in Twitch chat messages. *NCA 106th Annual Convention*.

Leith, A. P. (2020, May). Communicating closeness: Verbal immediacy as a predictor of parasocial relationships on Twitch. *ICA 70th Annual Conference*.

Leith, A. P. (2019, August). The affective messaging of gameplay livestream viewers. *Digital Games and Research Association Conference*. Kyoto, Japan.

Leith, A. P., Ratan, R. A., & Wohn, D. Y. (2013, June). The (de-)evolution of evolution games. *ICA 63rd Annual Conference*.

DeGroot, J. M., & Leith, A. P. (2011, November). R.I.P. Kutner: Parasocial relationships and grieving the death of a television character. *NCA 97th Annual Convention*.

Courses Taught

Southern Illinois University Edwardsville (Assistant/Associate Professor)

- **MC 590:** Independent Study in Mass Communications (Fall 2020)
- **MC 501:** Research Methods for Mass Communications (Fall 2024)
- **MC 471:** Special Topics — Introduction to Data Analytics in Journalism and Mass Communications (Fall 2019)
- **MC 471:** Special Topics — Social Media Analytics (Spring 2024)
- **MC 451:** Research Methods in Mass Media (Spring 2021, Spring 2022 – Spring 2024)
- **MC 422:** Strategic Media Writing (Fall 2025 – Spring 2026)

- **MC 327:** Design and Writing for the World Wide Web (Fall 2019 – Spring 2023, Spring 2024)
- **MC 323:** Digital Publishing and Design (Spring 2023 – Fall 2023)
- **FST 101:** Succeeding & Engaging at SIUE (Fall 2023)

Teaching Assistant — Michigan State University

COM 803: Intro to Quantitative Research Methods (Fall 2011) · TC 401: Social Media in Society (Fall 2013) · TC 401: Science Fiction, Communication, and Technology (Spring–Fall 2013) · MI 201: Introduction to Media and Information Technologies and Industries (Spring–Fall 2016) · MI 101: Understanding Media (Spring 2015 – Spring 2017)

Adjunct Instructor

McKendree University: JRN 372: Web and Print Publication Design (Spring 2012) · St. Louis College of Pharmacy: EN 3100: Professional Communication (Fall 2011 – Spring 2012) · SIUE: SPC 105: Public Speaking (Fall 2011), SPC 103: Interpersonal Communication (Fall 2010 – Fall 2011)

Service

Research Culture & Convening (cross-unit / interdisciplinary)

- Co-Founding Organizer, **Meaningful XR** (meaningfulxr.org). Beyond Meet Space initiative; annual conference convening researchers and practitioners around virtual presence, social VR, and mediated communication. 2023 – present. Stanford convening Jun 2023 – May 2024.
- Editor, **Journal of Media Psychology** (Hogrefe; Theories, Methods, and Applications). Mar 2023 – present. Co-Editor of Special Issue on Metaverse-Mediated Communication, 2024.
- **ICA Game Studies Division**, Student & Early Career Representative. Spring 2022 – Summer 2024.
- **ICA Game Studies Division**, Board Member. Oct 2021 – Jun 2024.
- **ICA**, Discord Moderator. Oct 2021 – present. Community-facing role moderating year-round scholarly discussion across ICA divisions.

Peer Review — Journals

Behaviour & Information Technology · Communication and Sports · Communication Monographs · Cyberpsychology, Behavior, and Social Networking · Death & Dying · Games & Culture · Information & Management · International Journal of Communication · Journal of Communication Technology · Journal of Gaming & Virtual Worlds · Mass Communication & Society · Media Psychology · Psychology of Popular Media · Technology, Mind, & Behavior

Peer Review — Conferences

ACM SIGCHI · AEJMC · CHI PLAY · DiGRA · Global Fusion · HICSS · ICA · Meaningful Play/XR · NCA

Departmental Service (SIUE)

- Program Coordinator, Faculty Discord Server (Dec 2023 – present). Department-internal cross-unit convening space for faculty.
- Technology Committee, Chair (Spring 2024 – Summer 2024); Member (Apr 2024 – present).
- Grant Committee, Member (Feb 2024 – present).
- ACEJMC Reaccreditation Committee, Member (Sep 2022 – Jan 2024).
- Mass Communications Week, Chair (Spring 2021 – Spring 2023). Annual department research-and-industry convening event.
- Website Committee, Member (Sept 2021 – present).
- Library Liaison (Aug 2020 – Spring 2024).
- Global Fusion Conference Committee, Member (Apr – Nov 2020).

College Service (SIUE)

- Program Review Committee, International Studies (Sept – Dec 2023).

University Service (SIUE)

- Search Committee Member, School of Engineering Dean Search (Spring 2026 – present).
- Task Force Member, Engagement in Asynchronous Classes (Summer 2020).
- Search Committee Member, Director of Student Financial Aid (Spring 2020 – Fall 2020).